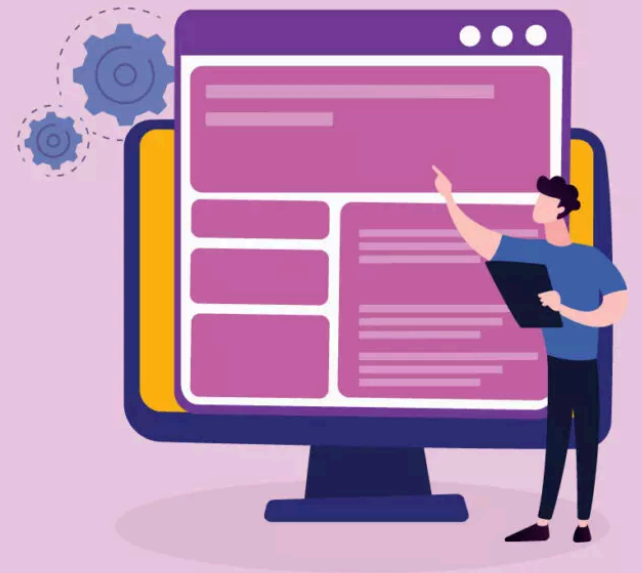


CSS Cheat Sheet: Types, Syntax, Concepts, & More

CSS Cheat Sheet

Explore the CSS cheat sheet to enrich the aesthetics of a web page using CSS selectors, pseudo selectors and elements, text and background styling, list styling, border properties, and more.



It was in 1994 that Håkon Wium Lie proposed the idea of CSS. In 1996, the first version of the same was invented. Since then many new additions and enhancements have been made and new versions of the CSS released.

CSS was invented to solve the problem of adding styling information to every single page of an HTML document. This blog will give you a CSS cheat sheet on all the necessary commands and properties so that you do not end up taking a lot of time with your website design.

What is CSS?

Cascading Style Sheet or CSS is a style sheet language used to define the style of a document written in a markup language such as [HTML or XML](#). It specifies the page layout, color, and font while the [HTML](#) deals with the structure of the web page. It is responsible for describing how [HTML elements](#) will look on the webpage. External stylesheets are also stored in CSS files.

Types of CSS

CCS is of three types. These are as follows.

1. External CSS

1. It is a separate style sheet that is later linked to the .html file. It includes a header section in the HTML document to link the external style sheet. It is used mainly to give a cleaner structure to our HTML files.

Example:

```
<head>
<link rel="stylesheet" type="text/css" href="mysitestyle.css">
</head>
```

2. Internal CSS

It is written directly into the header of the HTML document. It is useful when styling a single page.

Example:

```
<head>
<style>
Body { background-color: pink; }
P { font-size: 30px; color: blue; }
</style>
</head>
```

3. Inline CSS

It is a CSS block that is written directly into a single instance of HTML code.

Example:

```
<h1 style="font-size: 25px; color: blue;">This is the headline!</h1>
```

CSS Syntax

The CSS syntax consists of a selector and declaration block. Here an attribute is assigned values within the brackets following the name of the element that is to be styled.

Look at this sample syntax-

```
h2 {color: orange; font-size: 14px;}
```

Here the “h2” is the selector and the values in the bracket are declared.

CSS Concepts

There are basic to advanced commands in this CSS cheat sheet to get your cascading stylesheet started.

1. CSS Selectors

Selectors in CSS instruct the browser to find the HTML elements that are to be styled. Different types of CSS selectors are as follows:

Command	Description	Syntax
Universal Selector	It matches any type of element. It can be namespaced when utilizing @namespace.	{property:value;}
ID Selector	It matches an element based on the value of its id attribute.	Id {property:value;}
Class Selector	It matches the elements on the basis of the given class attribute.	.class {property:value;}
Type Selector	It matches elements based on their node names, that is, it selects all the elements of the given type.	h1, h2, h3 {property, value;}
Adjacent Sibling Selector	It is used to separate two selectors that are usually children of the same parent. A “+” sign denotes an adjacent sibling combinator.	h1+p {property, value;}
Child Selector	It is used to match the elements which are children of a specified element. A child combinator (>) is put between two CSS selectors to establish the relationship.	parent element>child element {property, value;}
General Sibling Selector	It matches all the elements that follow the first element where both are children of the same parent.	h1~p {property, value;}
Descendant Selector	It matches all the elements which are children of the element. But it selects the elements matched by the second selector only if they have an ancestor element matching the first selector.	element element {property, value;}

2. Pseudo-classes and Pseudo-elements

A pseudo-class is used for defining an element’s special state. Specific parts of an element are styled using pseudo-elements. Different types of pseudo-classes and pseudo-elements are as follows:

Command	Description	Syntax
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Move over Selector	It is used to target an element that we want to get triggered when the user hovers over it with the cursor.	a: hover {property, value;}
Active Link Selector	It is used to style the link that is clicked on. It is usually used with <a> and <button> elements.	a: active {property, value;}
Focus Selector	It is for the element that gets triggered when the user clicks or taps on it or selects it with the tab key.	input: focus {property, value;}
Visited Links Selector	It styles the links that have already been visited by the user.	: visited {property, value;}
Link Selector	It is used to select links that have not been visited.	.class: link {property, value;}
Checked Selector Element	It represents a radio, checkbox, or option element that is checked, selected, or toggled to an on-state.	input: checked {property, value;}
Disabled Elements Selector	It selects the disabled element.	input: disabled {property, value;}
Enabled Elements Selector	It selects the element that is currently enabled.	input: enabled {property, value;}
Not a Specified Element Selector	It selects the element that does not match a list of selectors.	: not(p) {}
First Line Selector	It is used to style the first line of a block-level element.	p: :first-line {property, value;}
First Letter Selector	It is used to style the first letter of the first line of a block-level element.	: :first-letter {property, value;}
First Child Selector	It represents the first element among the group of sibling elements.	: first-child {property, value;}
Last Child Selector	It represents the last element among the group of sibling elements.	: last-child {property, value;}
Only Child Selector	It is used to select the element without any siblings.	: only-child {property, value;}
:nth-child Selector	It selects elements based on their position.	: nth-child {property, value;}
The First Element of Its Parent Selector	It is used to target the first appearance of an element within a container.	P: first-of-type {property, value;}
Elements That Have No Children Selector	It represents the elements that do not have children.	p: empty {property, value;}
Before Element	It is used to define created content that comes before the content of an element.	class: :before {property, value;}
After Element	It is used to define created content that comes after the content of an element.	.class: :after {property, value;}

3. CSS Text Styling

Text Styling in CSS is used to style and format text. Here are different types of CSS text styling commands.

Command	Description	Syntax
Font Style	It defines the font style.	font-style: normal italic oblique
Font Variant	It defines the font variation.	font-variant: normal small-caps
Font Weight	It sets the weight of the font.	font-weight: normal bold bolder lighter 100 – 900
Vertical Alignment	It adjusts the alignment of the text.	vertical-align: baseline 10px sub super top text-top middle bottom text-bottom initial
Text Transform	It defines the case of the text, i.e. upper case, lower case, or capitalized.	text-transform: capitalise lowercase uppercase
Font Size	It defines the size of the font.	font-size: 12px 0.8em 60%
Space Between Characters	It is used to adjust the space between characters.	letter-spacing: normal 4px

Line Height	It is used to define the height of the line.	line-height: normal 3em 24%
Horizontal Alignment	It is used to align the text horizontally.	text-align: left right center justify
Text Align Last	It defines the orientation of the last line of a block before a forced line break.	text-align-last: auto left right center justify start end initial inherit
Text Decoration	It is used to specify the decoration to be added to a text. It is a shorthand property for text-decoration-line, text-decoration-color, text-decoration-style, and text-decoration-thickness.	text-decoration: none underline overline line-through
Indent First Line	It sets the indentation of the first line of the text block.	text-indent: 20px
Font Family	It specifies the font of an element. It can hold several font names as a “fallback” system where if the first font is not supported by the browser, the next font is tried.	font-family: ‘Open Sans’, sans-serif
Text Justify	It is used to specify the justification method of the text, i.e. how the text will be justified.	text-justify: auto inter-word inter-character none
Text Overflow	It is used to specify how the hidden overflowed content is signaled to the user.	text-overflow: clip ellipsis string initial inherit
Text Shadow	It adds a shadow to the text.	text-shadow: h-shadow v-shadow blur-radius color none initial inherit

4. CSS Table

The CSS Table commands are used to give styling instructions for the table in the HTML sheet. Various CSS Table commands are as follows:

Command	Description	Syntax
Adding Borders to Tables	The border property is used to define the borders of the table.	border: 2px solid black;
Adjusting Spacing Inside Tables	The padding property defines the padding or the space between the cell contents and cell borders.	th, td { padding: 20px;}
Width and Height	With the width and height property, we can specify not just the width and height for the table but the cells too.	table { width: 100%;} th { height: 20px;}
Table Layout	It is used to specify the layout for table cells, rows, and columns.	table { width: 200px; table-layout: fixed; }
Horizontal Alignment of Cell Contents	It is used to position a text inside the table cells horizontally.	th { text-align: left;}
Vertical Alignment of Cell Contents	It is used to align the content in the cells to the top, bottom, and center.	th {height: 20px; vertical-align: center;}
Making a Table Responsive	The overflow property is used to add responsiveness to the tables by allowing horizontal scrolling on tiny displays to support mobile devices.	<div style=“ overflow-x: auto;”> <table> table content </table> </div>

5. CSS Position

With position commands, one can specify how and where an element has to be displayed on a webpage. Here are some CSS Position commands:

Command	Description	Syntax
Position	It is used to set the position of the element in a document.	position: static relative absolute fixed sticky
Position Properties	It is used to define the final location of the positioned elements in a document.	top right bottom left
Float Element	It is used to define the position of an element in a document and inline elements to wrap around.	float: left right none
Clear Floating Elements	It is used to specify whether an element is supposed to be moved below the floating element that precedes it.	clear: none left right both

Z Index	It is used to set overlapping elements with a larger z-index to cover those with a smaller one.	z-index: 3 auto inherit
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6. CSS Background

Background commands are used to design the background and background effects for elements. Here are various CSS Background commands:

Command	Description	Syntax
Background Image	It is used to set a background image in a div.	background-image: url()
Background Repeat	It is used to set whether a background image should be repeated or not.	background-repeat: repeat-x repeat-y repeat space round no-repeat
Background Attachment	It is used to set how the background will move in relation to the view port.	background-attachment: scroll fixed local initial inherit
Background Color	It is used to set the background of a div or container.	background-color: #specify color
Background Position	It is used to set the position of the background.	background-position: top right bottom left center
Background Opacity	It is used to specify the opacity or transparency of a background. We can insert a value between 0.0 to 0.1. A low value will mean higher opacity.	div {background-color: color name; and opacity: value};

7. CSS Box Model

A Box Model is a box that wraps around an HTML element. Here are various CSS Box Model commands:

Command	Description	Syntax
Box Sizing	It sets the width and height of the box.	box-sizing: border-box content-box
Margin	It sets the margin from all sides of the box.	margin: 3px 6px 4px 7px 0 auto inherit
Padding	It sets the padding, i.e. space around the element inside the defined borders of the box.	padding: 3px 4px 4px 9px 100% inherit
Border Color	It is used to set the color of the box’s border.	border-color: #specify color
Border Style	It is used to set the style of the border.	border-style: none hidden dotted dashed solid double groove ridge inset outset
Border Width	It is used to set the width of the border. Up to four values can be added, that is, the width for the top, right, bottom, and left border can be specified.	border-width: thin 10px medium 20px;

8. CSS Styling Lists

Here are some commands that are used to style the list elements on a webpage:

Command	Description	Syntax
List Type	It is used to select the type of the list.	list-style-type: disc circle square none
List Position	It is used to set the position of the list.	list-style-position: inside outside
List Image	It is used to set the background image of the list.	list-style-image: url()

9. CSS Flexbox

A Flexbox or Flexible Box is used to make elements behave predictably when used with different screen sizes and different display devices. Here are various commands to style a CSS Flexbox.

Command	Description	Syntax
Flex Direction	It determines how flex items are placed in the flex container.	flex-direction: row row-reverse column column-reverse
Flex Wrap	It sets the flex items either to be in one line or wraps them into multiple lines.	flex-wrap: nowrap wrap wrap-reverse

Justify Content	It aligns the flexible items when they have not used all the available space on the main axis horizontally.	justify-content: flex-start flex-end center space-between space-around space-evenly
Align Items	It specifies the default alignment for items inside a flex or grid container.	align-items: flex-start flex-end center baseline stretch
Align Content	It determines the space between and around the content.	align-content: flex-start flex-end center space-between space-around stretch
Order	It sets the order to lay out an item in a flex or grid container.	order: 0
Flex Grow	It specifies how much the item will grow relative to the rest of the flexible items inside the same container.	flex-grow: 0
Flex Shrink	It is used to reduce the size of a flexible item.	flex-shrink: 0
Flex Basis	It is used to set the initial length of a flexible box. If “auto” is used as the value, the size will be decided according to the content.	flex-basis: 3px auto
Align Self	It is used to align the items inside the grid area.	align-self: auto flex-start flex-end center baseline stretch

10. CSS Grid

CSS Grid helps in making a grid-based layout system with rows and columns. It enables the user to align elements into rows and columns. Here are various CSS Grid commands.

Command	Description	Syntax
Grid Template Columns	It defines the number of columns along with their width in a grid layout.	grid-template-columns: none auto max-content min-content length initial inherit;
Grid Template Rows	It defines the number of rows along with their height in a grid layout.	grid-template-rows: none auto max-content min-content length initial inherit;
Grid Template Areas	It specifies areas within the grid layout.	grid-template-areas: none itemnames;
Grid Template	It is a property to define grid rows, columns, and areas.	grid-template: none grid-template-rows / grid-template-columns grid-template-areas initial inherit;
Grid Column Gap	It sets the size of the gap between columns in a grid.	grid-column-gap: length;
Grid Row Gap	It sets the size of the gap between rows in a grid.	grid-row-gap: length;
Justify Items	It defines the default justify-self for all items of the box.	justify-items: start end center stretch
Align Items	It sets the align-self value on all direct child elements as a group.	align-items: start end center stretch
Justify Content	It specifies how space will be distributed by the browser between and around the content.	justify-content: flex-start flex-end center space-between space-around space-evenly
Align Content	It is used in a grid container to align grid items in the block direction.	align-content: stretch center flex-start flex-end space-between space-around space-evenly initial inherit;
Grid Auto Columns	It defines the size of an implicitly-created grid column track or pattern of tracks.	grid-auto-columns: 100px max-content min-content
Grid Auto Rows	It defines the size of an implicitly-created grid row track or pattern of tracks.	grid-auto-rows: 100px max-content min-content
Grid Auto Flow	It controls how auto-placed items are inserted in a grid.	grid-auto-flow: row column row dense column dense
Grid Column Start	It specifies the start position of a grid item within the grid column.	grid-column-start: 2 areaname span 2 span areaname auto
Grid Column End	It specifies how many columns an item will span or on which column-line the item will end.	grid-column-end: 2 areaname span 2 span areaname auto
Grid Row Start	It specifies the start position of a grid item within the grid row.	grid-row-start: 2 areaname span 2 span areaname auto

Grid Row End	It specifies how many rows an item will span or on which row-line the item will end.	grid-row-end: 2 areaname span 2 span areaname auto
Grid Column	It specifies the size and location of a grid item within the grid column.	grid-column: 3 / span 2
Grid Row	It specifies the size and location of a grid item within the grid row.	grid-row: 3 / span 2
Justify Self	It defines the way a box is justified inside its alignment container along the appropriate axis.	justify-self: start end center stretch
Align Self	It overrides a grid or flex item’s align-items value.	align-self: start end center stretch

11. CSS Content (Dynamic)

Here are some CSS content selectors and properties:

Command	Description	Syntax
CSS Variable	It is used in other declarations using the var() function.	–variable-name: value
Variable Usage	It is used in other declarations using the var() function.	var (–variable-name)
Counter Reset	It creates a new counter or reversed counter with the given name on the specified element.	counter-reset: name-of-counter
Counter Increment	It is used to increase or decrease the value of a CSS counter.	counter-increment: name-of-counter
Counter Dynamic Value	Content property inserts the generated content. Counter adds the value of a counter to an element.	content: counter (name-of-counter)
Attribute Dynamic Value	It is used to adjust the appearance of content based on its location in a document.	content: attr (name-of-attribute)

Conclusion

CSS is important when it comes to styling HTML documents cleanly and efficiently. The commands and properties mentioned in this cheat sheet are, thus, essential for web developers and those interested in web design. You can always keep a CSS cheat sheet PDF handy for a quick look for interview or exam preparation.